AVAILABLE FOR LICENSING

DOWN FOR THE COUNT

A wrestling climbing card game for 2–6 players · Last one standing wins.

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THE GAME

Every card in your hand is a move you can still make. Climb the move on the table with a bigger set or run, or take a count to stay in it: a reversal steals a card off the move, a kick out pulls one of your face-down count cards into your hand. Play your last card and you tap out; take one count too many and you're pinned. The last wrestler standing wins the round. Three rounds make a match.

WHY IT WORKS

- **Cards are stamina.** A climbing game where emptying your hand knocks you out, so every card spent is one you can't answer with later. Players play the cheapest move that climbs and sweat the rest.
- **The count is a clock.** Two or three face-down cards per wrestler, open for everyone to see. Each count spent buys a card and moves you one step closer to the pin.
- **Finishers.** A move nobody can answer costs three or four cards: against a wrestler with no count left it ends their round, against anyone else it's a gift.
- **One deck, 2 to 6.** Sixty cards, the same rules at every count. Hand and count sizes are tuned by simulation for each player count; heads-up is a quick duel.

Tapped out	*Pinned*	*Last standing*
Play your last card	No count left and no answer	Wins the round

AT A GLANCE

PLAYERS	2–6 (one deck, hand and count sizes by player count)
GENRE	Climbing card game, last one standing
LENGTH	About 15 minutes, 3 short rounds
COMPONENTS	60 cards (ranks 1–10, six of each), small box
READY	Rules, print-and-play, browser build with bots, balance simulations

Play it now darrendon.github.io/games/down-for-the-count